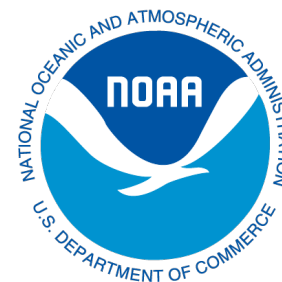


Alaska-wide Sablefish Stock Assessment

-- CIE Review --



16-18 June 2026



NOAA
FISHERIES

Getting started

- Introductions
- Logistics
- Common acronyms
- Engagement process
- Meeting norms and behaviors
- Meeting terms of reference
- Agenda

Why are ecologists so great at peer reviews?



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*Why are ecologists so great
at peer reviews?*

-- They know how to handle feedback loops! --



Introductions

- Chris Lunsford – NOAA Fisheries project contact
- Aaron Berger – Review chair
- Klass Hartman – CIE Reviewer
- Peter Stephenson – CIE Reviewer
- Samuel Subbey – CIE Reviewer
- Sablefish assessment authors
 - Daniel Goethel
 - Matt Cheng
- Additional support
 - Sara Cleaver
 - Kevin Siwicke
 - Katy Echave
 - MESA, AFSC, NPFMC

Logistics

- Bathrooms
- Wifi
- Food/lunch this week
- Office space
- Other needs?

Acronyms

- AFSC -- Alaska Fisheries Science Center
- NPFMC -- North Pacific Fisheries Management Council
- AK -- Alaska
- GOA -- Gulf of Alaska
- BS -- Bering Sea
- AI -- Aleutian Islands
- LLS -- NOAA Longline Survey
- RPN -- Relative Population Numbers (survey index in numbers)
- LLF -- Longline Fishery (composed of hook-and-line and longline pot gear), a.k.a. the fixed gear fleet
- TF -- Trawl Fishery (composed of pelagic and bottom trawl gear)
- FAA -- fleets-as-areas spatially implicit model

Engagement process

Goal: efficient yet thorough review following the terms of reference

- Topic structured agenda with a presentation – discussion format.
- Questions/comments taken during the presentation followed by a dedicated time for overall discussion.
- If questions can not be immediately addressed, the science team may take additional time to collate a response (as applicable) during the meeting.
- Engagement outcomes – two tier focus:
 1. Scientific recommendations given the current modeling work
 2. Scientific recommendations related to the current work that requires future research

Meeting norms and behaviors

All participants are responsible for holding each other accountable to the following ground rules. Reports of inappropriate behavior will be taken seriously and followed through to resolution following the appropriate procedures. Please direct any concerns to the chair (aaron.berger@noaa.gov).

- a. Treat everyone with respect.
- b. Listen and seek to understand differing views or opinions.
- c. In most cases, wait to be recognized by the chair or speaker before speaking.
Do not interrupt or engage in side-conversations when others have the floor.
- d. Represent information honestly and openly.
- e. Refrain from using offensive, disrespectful, or derogatory language.
- f. Personal or organizational attacks or insults will not be tolerated.
- g. Allow for a balance of speaking time, as appropriate, following the Engagement process guidance.

Terms of reference – peer review

- 1) Review the disseminated documents and analyses, then provide feedback on whether the fleets-as-areas (FAA) assessment provides a suitable basis for operational management advice, particularly in comparison to the current single region panmictic assessment.
 - a) Provide recommendations on the most appropriate parametrization of fleet structure (number of fleets per fishery/survey, as a proxy for regions) in the FAA model.
- 2) Highlight potential strengths and weaknesses of the FAA assessment, including model assumptions, estimates, fits to data (survey indices and age compositions along with fishery catch-at-age data), model diagnostics, and major sources of uncertainty.
 - a) Indicate whether the model provides the best scientific information available for estimating current stock status, projecting future abundance, and determining Overfishing Levels (OFLs) and Acceptable Biological Catches (ABCs).
- 3) Provide research recommendations for improving the existing research-oriented sablefish spatial (i.e., 3 and 5 region) assessment models, especially in the context of potential future usage in a management context.

Agenda

Tuesday, June 16, 2026

A. Welcome and Introductions

09:00 — 09:15: Welcoming Remarks, Introductions, Logistics Chris Lunsford
09:15 — 09:30: Announcements, Agenda/ToRs Aaron Berger

B. Sablefish Management, Biology, Fishery, and Data Inputs (ToR 1)

09:30 — 09:50: Sablefish Background, Biology, and Spatial Dynamics Daniel Goethel
09:50 — 10:10: Fishing History and Fishery-Dependent Data Chris Lunsford
10:10 — 10:30: Sablefish Management/NPFMC FMP Requirements Sara Cleaver

10:30 — 10:50: *BREAK*

10:50 — 11:15: Longline Survey Data and Recent Design Changes Pat Malecha
11:30 — 12:00: Data Available for the Sablefish Assessment Daniel Goethel
12:00 — 12:30: Discussion

12:30 — 14:00: *LUNCH BREAK*

C. Assessment Model Configuration (ToR 1)

14:00 — 15:30: General Sablefish Assessment Parametrization Daniel Goethel

15:30 — 15:50: *BREAK*

15:50 — 17:00: Discussion

Wednesday, June 17, 2026

A. Reconvene

09:00 — 09:15: Announcements, Agenda/ToRs Aaron Berger
09:15 — 10:30: Discussion

10:30 — 10:50: *BREAK*

B. Fleets-as-Areas Model Configuration (ToRs 1)

10:50 — 12:00: Results of Spatial Simulations to Understand FAA Structure Matt Cheng
12:00 — 12:30: Discussion

12:30 — 14:00: *LUNCH BREAK*

C. Comparing Assessment Performance and Diagnostics (ToR 1/2)

14:00 — 15:30: Outputs/Diagnostics for FAA and Single Region Models Daniel Goethel

15:30 — 15:50: *BREAK*

15:50 — 17:00: Discussion

Agenda

Thursday, June 18, 2026

A. Reconvene

09:00 — 09:15: Announcements, Agenda/ToRs

Aaron Berger

B. Comparing Assessment Performance and Diagnostics (ToR 1/2)

09:15 — 10:30: Discussion

10:30 — 10:50: *BREAK*

C. Spatial Models (ToR 3)

10:50 — 12:30: 3 and 5 Region Spatial Model Configuration/Outputs

Matt Cheng

12:30 — 14:00: *LUNCH BREAK*

14:00 — 15:30: Discussion

15:30 — 15:50: *BREAK*

15:50 — 17:00: Discussion and Report Writing

ADJOURN

[Review Google Drive Link](#)

[Review GitHub Link](#)

Day 1 Summary

Day 2 Summary